Setting the 2027 Agenda: Re-Examining the Discourse on Good Governance and the Nigerian Broadcast Media

Ph.D. Ibrahim Uba Yusuf, Ph.D. Yahaya Abubakar, Ph.D. Musa Usman

Abstract

This study is a conceptual work that analysed the place of Nigerian broadcast media in the context of discourses on democracy, good governances and elections. The paper leveraged on numerous related literatures to provide context, re-examine the broadcast media landscape and also advance the position that the broadcast media, despite its contemporary challenges that include proliferation of digital platforms, poor resources and pressure from different groups, still remain relevant and continue to provide effective platform for critical discourse on political matters. The paper utilises the tenets of democratic participant theory to explain good governance and the role of the media Methodologically, the paper relied on secondary data and observation of the radio and television programmes as well as broadcast schedules of selected media stations to examine past experiences and current efforts by Nigerian broadcast media in engaging the public through intentional programme contents to set agenda for the 2027 elections and expectations for good governance. Thus, findings from the analysis revealed that despite the proliferation of media channels that include digital media platforms, which all contribute significantly to political discourse and good governance, the broadcast media as popular traditional media channels continue to retain and consolidate on its traditional role in political mobilisation and participation in the contemporary time. Therefore, the study concludes that the role of broadcast media is imperative in promoting good governance by holding government accountable to people and ensuring transparency and justice in any democratic setting like Nigeria through its efforts to provide a platform and various forums for political debates, discussions and conversations through interviews, current affairs and discussion programmes in both national and local broadcast stations. In view of this, it is recommended that broadcast stations should strengthen their programmes on political matters to be accessible and participatory and the regulatory body such as the National Broadcasting Commission should also continue to formulate and strengthen policies that would continue to guide the broadcast media in their dealings with political matters.

Keywords: Broadcast media, Good governance, Agenda, Elections

Introduction

As Nigeria approaches the 2027 general elections, questions of good governance are likely to occupy a central place in political and public discourse (including the media). Issues such as accountability, transparency, responsiveness, service delivery, citizens' participation and respect for the rule of law remain important to how governance is discussed and evaluated. In this context, the broadcast media occupies a significant position in shaping public conversations, providing platforms for political actors and citizens, and bringing governance issues to wider audiences. According to Akingbohungbe (2025) good governance remains a critical ingredient for the growth, unity, and transformation of any nation; and in a country like Nigeria, where it is blessed with human and natural resources, the struggle for good governance has continued to be at the centre stage of national debates. It is obvious that institutions, laws, and leadership play central roles in governance, the media, both traditional (television, radio, newspaper and magazine) and digital are also powerful catalysts for shaping democratic outcomes and ensuring governmental accountability. This is largely achieved through intentional and sustained contents by media organisations including the broadcast media (television and radio).

According to Malam (2022), broadcasting is one of such endeavours that are inseparable from politics. This is because through the broadcast media, broadcasting has become a tool that is used for mobilisation and bringing about change. Broadcast media as communication channels have for many years provided a platform for political discourse. Observably, various television and radio stations in Nigeria have introduced programmes in their broadcast schedules that are often designed to increase political mobilisation, participation and track governance. Such programmes can include current affairs, discussion programmes among others that target electorates as well as sensitize the public on good governance. Citizens can only demand for accountability, fair election and justice when they are informed, aware and participate in decision-making processes that can ultimately bring about good governance. This position aligns with the perspectives of some scholars such as McQuail (2010), who notes that in politics, the mass media provides an arena for debate and also set channels for making policies, candidates, relevant facts and ideas widely known as well as providing politicians, interest groups and agents of government with means of publicity influence.

Paletz (2008) also posits that the media are indispensable to democracy, a political system predicated on the consent of the governed. Paletz further argues that the media expresses political contents in four different ways that occasionally overlap, which include explicit and intentional contents such as debates, adverts and commentary; explicit and unintentional contents; implicit and intentional contents as well as implicit and unintentional contents. The explicit and intentional contents on broadcast media such as debates, adverts and commentaries are usually programmed to achieve a particular goal. Thus, these intentional programmes, particularly those related to politics and good governance can set an agenda and subtly aid in forming public opinions on critical issues. Baym (2013) on the other hand notes that one form of political media is the public-affairs interview. As much as political media have changed, the one-on-one interview remains a primary mode of political engagement.

Thus, the media including the broadcast media play a significant role at different phases in political change, particularly during elections. Yusuf, Abubakar and Adamu (2025) note that the role of the media during election periods can be examined across three broad phases: the pre-election phase, the election phase and the post-election phase. In each of these stages, the responsibilities of the media assume different dimensions and objectives. This is largely because the media function as critical actors within the democratic process and therefore play significant roles in shaping political communication, public awareness and setting agenda during the electoral cycle.

The pre-election phase is particularly important because it lays the foundation for informed political participation. This phase is often characterised by intense political party activities such as candidate nominations, campaign mobilisation, policy articulation and coalition building. Within this period, the mainstream media become highly active as political developments generate a steady flow of newsworthy events and issues for public dissemination. For media organisations, it is also a period of increased commercial activity as political actors purchase airtime and advertising space to communicate their messages to the electorate. Baym (2010) notes that politicians have wider televisual resources at their disposal to make arguments, influence opinions, and build constituencies. Likewise, contemporary citizens, in their efforts to engage with, and perhaps find pleasure in, the political domain, are drawing on any number of programs and generic configurations that crisscross categories of news and entertainment, and politics and pop culture. It is apparent that public discourse is no longer contained, nor constrained, by the high-modernist institutions and discursive structures once narrowly assumed to constitute the legitimate arena for the exercise of representative politics.

Beyond the commercial opportunities, the pre-election period places a significant democratic responsibility on the media. Through the wide range of political content produced and disseminated during this time, the media provide civic and voter education by informing citizens about electoral procedures, voter registration

requirements, the rights and responsibilities of voters and the importance of peaceful participation in the democratic process. By doing so, the media helps prepare citizens for meaningful engagement in the electoral process.

Interestingly, the Nigerian government in a bid to ensure good governance in the country had in, the 1999 Nigerian constitution, Section 16 (1) a, b, c, and d, and Section 16 (2) rooted some of the principles of good governance as possible criteria for governance in the country. These provisions seem ineffective despite enormous financial resources, and huge potentials of the country, including the social and economic policies that have been implemented by successive administrations. Good governance continues to be elusive to Nigeria. Therefore, it becomes imperative to recognise the effort of media organisations particularly the broadcast media in complementing efforts towards achieving good governance through its effort to mobilise, sensitize and create awareness about government policies and programmes.

Effective and efficient governance is integral to any country's wellbeing. The concept of governance is contextualised in this paper as the exercise of power or authority (political, economic, administrative or otherwise) to manage a country's resources and affairs. It comprises the mechanisms, processes and institutions through which citizens and groups articulate their interests, exercise their legal rights, meet their obligations and mediate their differences.

The main strategy of having effective and efficient governance is to relate to the functioning of the public sector focused on accountability and scrutiny and the performance of the public sector on the connection between policy and implementation. It provides a concept that allows the public to discuss the role of government in coping with public issues and the contribution that other players may make. It opens one's mind to the possibility that groups in society other than the government (for example, 'communities' or the 'voluntary sector') may have to play a stronger role in addressing problems.

This paper is interested in discussing the 2027 Nigeria's general election and how the broadcast can help in setting the agenda for the public through its content. At present, political parties are intensifying their preparations for the 2027 General Elections, with candidates emerging for various elective positions across the country. Candidates of the ruling All Progressives Congress (APC) and opposition parties have increasingly utilised the media to present their programmes, policy positions and development plans to Nigerians and their respective constituencies. This growing presence of political actors in the broadcast media provides an important context for examining the nature and substance of political broadcast programmes and the extent to which they engage with issues of good governance. With the electoral cycle already underway and political campaigns subject to the timetable and regulations issued by the Independent National Electoral Commission (INEC), the media is expected to play a significant role in shaping public discourse leading to the 2027 elections.

While the Frankfurt School for example have the view that media contents are negative because in their context the Nazi, Germans used radio, newspapers, films and television to disseminate propaganda and were pivotal in the spread of capitalist ideology, this paper argues that media contents are a mixture of positive and negative. The paper is segmented into the following sections. First, it provides an excursion on Nigerian Broadcast Media and the past experience on good governance in relations to the elections. The section limits discourse to Kano broadcasts and political programmes as well as the discourse on media at the national level. This paper is useful as it provides a basis for examining political broadcast programmes in relation to their engagement with issues of good governance. It advocates a shift from personality centred political discourse towards issue based and governance centred communication, with greater emphasis on accountability, transparency, public participation and citizens' concerns.

Contextualising Broadcast media and its Role in Governance

On 5 March 2026, the international broadcast network Al Jazeera aired one of its regular programmes, Head-to-Head with Mehdi Hasan, featuring Nigeria's Presidential Adviser on Communication and Policy, Daniel Bwala. The interview attracted considerable attention within Nigeria's media and political circles and remained a subject of public discourse across both mainstream and digital platforms. Commentators, political actors and citizens reflected on the issues raised during the exchange, particularly those relating to governance, accountability and the broader dynamics of political communication in democratic societies.

However, the prominence of this interview also raises important questions about the role of Nigerian based broadcasters in shaping conversations on governance within the country. While Nigerian broadcast media organisations such as Channels Television, African Independent Television (AIT), Arise News, News Central TV, TVC News and the public owned Nigerian Television Authority regularly host programmes that provide platforms for public office holders and public affairs analysts to discuss national issues, the interview in question originated from an international broadcaster.

In the buildup to the 2027 general elections, issues surrounding the removal and possible reinstatement of petrol subsidy have once again become prominent in the Nigerian media. The debate was recently reignited following the renewed position of Atiku Abubakar, presidential candidate of the African Democratic Congress (ADC), that a form of petrol subsidy should be restored. The proposal generated a response from the All Progressives Congress (APC) Presidential Campaign Council, which challenged him to explain its legal, fiscal and operational implications, including its proposed cost, source of funding and mechanism for ensuring that consumers benefit. Such debates are important governance issues that should receive sustained attention in political broadcast programmes. Rather than merely reporting exchanges between political actors, broadcasters have an opportunity to interrogate the substance of competing positions and provide citizens with the information required to understand their implications. Questions concerning the economic consequences of subsidy removal, the proposed mechanism for its restoration, the cost to public finances, accountability for subsidy expenditure from the time of removal to date, and its likely effects on fuel prices and the wider cost of living warrant thorough public discussion.

The fuel subsidy debate is one among many other issues that demonstrate the broader role of the broadcast media in setting the governance agenda for the 2027 elections. This development calls for reflection on the extent to which Nigerian broadcast media are proactively creating platforms that rigorously interrogate governance issues and stimulate substantive public debate. It raises a fundamental question about whether the broadcast media are adequately setting the agenda for governance conversations as the country approaches the 2027 general elections. Consequently, there is a need to re-examine the role of Nigerian broadcast media in promoting accountability, stimulating informed political discourse and strengthening democratic engagement during the electoral cycle.

Nigerian Broadcast Media and Good Governance: The Past Experiences

Mass media are critical stakeholders in ensuring the accountability of government to the governed through providing information for the citizens to hold those in authority accountable. According to Curran (2002), they help in promoting what is right in the society and also serve as platforms for articulating citizens' voices and preference for government to use in policy formulation. Regardless of format or nature (broadcast, print or online), media has a significant role in boosting good governance. The roles of the media in good governance can be underscored under eight (8) perspectives which include participation, transparency, responsiveness, equity and inclusiveness. According to UNESCO (2005), participation is a crucial element for good governance. The media enables participation in two ways; as a facilitator providing platforms for the citizens to have accurate and sufficient information that help citizens make rational and informed decisions and take the right course of action beneficial to them: As a feedback mechanism, the media provide the means for the

citizens to register their feelings and express their assent and dissent concerning issues. The media as the primary intermediaries of information supply the information that other sectors of the society need to participate effectively.

Among the various elements of good governance, transparency is widely recognised as a core principle (Bellver & Kaufmann, 2005). The media can play a key role in increasing government accountability to the general public by explaining government policies and actions in this manner; what is to be done, how and why an action has to take place, who is involved and by what standards decisions are made, and in this way government actions and inactions are exposed to the glare of the general public. It is perhaps in the area of engendering transparency in the society that the Nigerian media continue to be acknowledged (Olutokun & Seteolu, 2001; Jibo & Okoosi-Simbine, 2003). Good governance also requires that institutions and processes try to serve all stakeholders within a reasonable timeframe, by responding to the grievances, needs and aspirations of the citizens. As mentioned earlier, the media act as a feedback mechanism where the publics are given the opportunity to bring their plight to the notice of the State. The media often do this through various media campaigns and programmes that serve to remind the State of their obligations to the public. Moreover, the wellbeing of society depends on ensuring that all members have a uniform stake in it which requires all groups, particularly the most vulnerable, to have opportunities to improve and/or maintain their wellbeing. The media's role in this regard is very simple- giving balanced and fair coverage to all issues in a manner that diverse voices and opinions will be represented. It is perhaps in this function that the Nigerian media have been greatly faulted. The Nigerian media have been accused of prejudice in reporting and treating issues of public concern.

Arguably, the broadcast media terrain in Nigeria has evolved into a highly competitive and influential sector that plays a significant role in shaping governance discourse. Malam (2022) argues that the emergence of private radio and television stations following the deregulation of the broadcast sector has contributed to the dissemination of diverse political views and opinions. By the existence of broadcast media (private and public), they have contributed to an emerging liberal democratic space that promotes free flow of contending political views which seems to be absent in the days of public ownership monopoly of the broadcast media. Through news bulletins, political talk shows and public affairs programmes, broadcast media have become central platforms for interrogating public policies, scrutinising political actors and facilitating citizen participation in governance. Over the years, radio and television stations across the country have hosted programmes that enable citizens, political elites and policy experts to debate issues of national importance. In this regard, broadcast media have contributed to strengthening democratic culture by promoting public engagement with governance processes.

This section examines past experiences of Nigerian broadcast media in advancing conversations on good governance from two perspectives. The first focuses on programmes aired on broadcast media with national outlook, while the second part examines the role of political programmes by FM radio stations in Kano State. The choice of Kano is deliberate, as the state can be regarded as a major centre of political activity in Northern Nigeria. Kano also has a large concentration of broadcast media organisations, making it an appropriate setting for examining the nature and extent of political broadcasting and the interrogation of good governance issues in the lead up to the 2027 general elections.

Good Governance Discourse at the National Level

Nigerian broadcast media also contribute to governance discourse through nationally televised political programmes. Television networks often host high profile discussions that bring together political leaders, government officials, opposition figures and policy analysts to deliberate on national issues. For instance, programmes such as Politics Today and Daily Politics on Channels Television and Trust Television have

become influential platforms for discussing governance issues in Nigeria. Through interviews, panel discussions and policy analysis, these programmes examine government policies, electoral developments, legislative activities and public administration challenges daily. They provide viewers with insights into the workings of government while also creating opportunities for public scrutiny of political actors.

It should be noted that the broadcast media at the national level have the capacity to make a significant contribution to the interrogation of governance issues. The Nigerian Television Authority (NTA), as the national public broadcaster, is particularly positioned to provide a platform for sustained discussion of public policies, government performance and issues affecting citizens. However, concerns about government influence and control over the public broadcaster raise questions about the extent to which it can effectively perform its role in tracking good governance. Olaiya, Apeoko and Ayeni (2013) argue that the media must be guaranteed freedom and independence in the discharge of their professional responsibilities. The degree of media independence is closely associated with its capacity to scrutinise public affairs, hold political leaders accountable and serve the public interest.

Broadcast programmes related to politics can therefore serve as important mechanisms of accountability by questioning political leaders, seeking explanations for government actions and subjecting policy proposals to public scrutiny. Through such engagements, the media contribute to transparency and informed public debates, while providing citizens with opportunities to assess competing political claims and governance positions. These programmes also demonstrate the capacity of broadcast media to shape national conversations by determining which governance issues receive sustained public attention. The effectiveness of this role, however, depends largely on the extent to which broadcasters can operate with professional autonomy and provide critical, balanced and evidence-based interrogation of political and governance issues.

Broadcast Media and Good Governance: The Kano Experience

Programmes on good governance are usually tied to politics. Political programming on FM radio stations in Kano State demonstrates the vibrant nature of broadcast media engagement with governance issues at the sub national level. Radio remains one of the most accessible media platforms in northern parts of Nigeria, largely because of its affordability, linguistic inclusiveness and ability to reach audiences across urban and rural communities. Thus, FM radio stations in Kano provide important platforms for citizens to discuss political developments, express their opinions and question public authorities.

Political programmes across FM stations in Kano are diverse in format and orientation. They include public discussions, policy debates, audience phone in segments and interviews with political actors. These programmes provide opportunities for citizens to articulate their views on governance, public policies and political leadership. As noted by Siraj (2016), almost all FM radio stations in Kano broadcast political programmes that focus on governance and public affairs. Some of the notable programmes include:

Name of Programme

Station of Broadcast

Ko Wanne Gauta

Freedom Radio

Siyasar Kano

Pyramid FM

Iya Ruwa

Radio Kano 2 FM

Harshenka Alkalinka

Rahma Radio

Kasuwar Bukata

Wazobia FM

Ido Ba Mudu Ba

Express FM

Table 1: Programmes broadcast on radio stations in Kano tied to good governance

The programmes highlighted in Table 1 provide platforms for discussing public policies, electoral processes, governance challenges and socio-economic issues affecting citizens. Through such engagements, radio stations facilitate political participation and contribute to democratic accountability. Citizens visit these stations and are provided with opportunities to access airtime to express their views, raise concerns and comment on issues relating to good governance in Kano State and Nigeria more broadly. Observably, the stations allocate varying amounts of airtime depending on the nature of the programme, the issue under discussion and, in some instances, the ability of individuals or organisations to pay for airtime. This commercial dimension may influence citizens' access to broadcast platforms and the extent to which different voices are represented in public discourse.

Nevertheless, the programmes provide an important avenue through which citizens can question public officials, express dissatisfaction with government policies and draw attention to issues affecting their communities. An important feature of these programmes is the provision of a right of reply, particularly where allegations are made against government agencies, public institutions or political office holders. Such opportunities can promote fairness and balance by allowing individuals or institutions that are the subject of criticism or allegations to respond. In this regard, political broadcast programmes can serve as platforms for public scrutiny, dialogue and accountability, thereby strengthening the role of radio in promoting good governance and democratic engagement. A number of individuals, including Dan Bilki Commander, Alhaji Nagoda, Ali Baba and others, regularly appear as guests on these radio programmes. Their recurrent participation provides opportunities for sustained discussion of public policies, governance challenges and issues affecting citizens even though it is viewed by others as broadcast political thuggery because of their utterances. While the presence of these individuals does not, in itself, establish that the programmes promote good governance, their engagements can contribute to keeping governance related issues within the public domain.

Another example is the Hausa television series Kwana Casa'in, produced and broadcast by Arewa24, a Hausa satellite television station in Kano, with support from the MacArthur Foundation. The series uses fictional narratives to portray political and socio-economic realities, including corruption, abuse of public office and other governance challenges. Through its dramatic representation of these issues, the programme provides an alternative form of political communication through which audiences can reflect on the consequences of corrupt practices and the responsibilities of political office holders.

The multiplicity of political programmes across different broadcast stations reflects the pluralistic nature of the Nigerian broadcast media environment. These programmes are not necessarily monolithic in their perspective; rather, they provide spaces for diverse political interests, ideological positions and analytical viewpoints. Such diversity creates opportunities for governance issues to be debated from different

perspectives and enables citizens to encounter competing interpretations of political policies and government performance. In this sense, the plurality of political broadcast programmes can contribute to a more expansive public sphere in which citizens engage with governance issues, scrutinise political claims and participate in democratic discourse.

Good Governance Agenda and Broadcast Media in Nigeria

As Nigeria prepares for another round of elections in 2027, the broadcast media can reflect on its past and present challenges as well its potentials to add value to the political activities in the country. The role of the broadcast media in these activities should be targeted towards holding everyone responsible and accountable for good governance before and after elections; either as electorates or political candidates. The aftermath of every election comes with the expectation for good governance. Good governance provides transparency, accountability and social and physical developments. Abraham (2021) argues that the role of the media in promoting good governance is clear. All aspects of good governance are facilitated by a strong and independent mediascape within a society. Only when journalists are free to monitor, investigate and criticize the public administration's policies and actions can good governance take hold. Thus, the author identified two key activities that can promote good governance; active participation and civic forum for political debates, which can both be facilitated by the broadcast media. It is important for Nigerian broadcast media to resist pressure from political parties, political candidates, pressure groups and even electorates in discharging their duties and also insist on freedom of expression and the role of the mass media as enshrined in the 1999 Constitution of the Federal Republic of Nigeria as amended. This can further be consolidated when journalists adhere strictly to journalism ethical standards.

The broadcast media can contribute significantly to the promotion of good governance and the development of a fair and just political system, particularly as Nigeria approaches another electoral cycle in 2027. To fulfil this responsibility, broadcasters need to recognise and utilise the distinctive potentials of radio and television. Ogah and Abari (2023) identify eight potentials that make broadcasting a unique medium: flexibility, omnipresence, voracity, regularity, anonymity, heterogeneity, mode of transmission and immediacy. These characteristics provide broadcast media with the capacity to reach diverse audiences, disseminate information rapidly, facilitate continuous public discussion and provide platforms for citizens and political actors to engage in issues of public concern.

This potential becomes particularly significant during election periods. In Nigeria, the organisation of political debates involving presidential and other candidates has become an important feature of communicating politics and interrogating good governance. Such debates provide broadcast media with opportunities to set the agenda by determining the issues presented to candidates and the questions through which their policy positions are examined. Beyond providing candidates with an opportunity to communicate their programmes, electoral debates can enable broadcasters to subject competing policy proposals to public scrutiny and encourage candidates to address issues of governance, accountability and citizens' welfare.

Consequently, the effectiveness of electoral debates should not be measured merely by the number of candidates given airtime or the size of the audience reached. Greater attention should be given to the issues selected for discussion, the depth of questioning, the opportunity provided for candidates to substantiate their claims and the extent to which citizens' governance concerns are reflected in the debates.

Good Governance and Media: Democratic Media Participant Theory

Central to this discourse on good governance is the media democratic theory. The media in all its forms provides an obvious conduit for democratic participation and education. The theory is an extension by McQuail in 1987. Democratic Participant Theory is often seen as a development of Social Responsibility

Theory, although it is more accurately described as a response that extends its ideas. While Social Responsibility Theory emphasises ethical media practice and service to the public, Democratic Participant Theory places stronger focus on the active involvement of citizens in media processes.

The theory proposes that the media should support and promote the views and opinions of individuals regarding governance, leadership, and public accountability. It highlights the importance of equal and unrestricted access to media, regardless of status, wealth, or social position. Participation in decision making within society and involvement in communication activities should not be limited to elites but should be open to all citizens.

A key principle of the theory is the decentralisation of media power. It encourages the growth of community and small-scale media platforms so that diverse voices can be heard. In this regard, governments are expected to identify, train, and provide funding for smaller media organisations, while still preserving their independence. According to Baran and Davis (2012), Democratic Participant Theory supports cultural pluralism at the grassroots level. Media should be used to stimulate and empower diverse groups within society, enabling them to represent their own interests and perspectives. The theory also emphasises that audiences should not remain passive consumers of media content. Instead, individuals should actively create, share, and influence media messages. This ensures a more inclusive and participatory communication environment.

Good governance rests on principles such as transparency, accountability, inclusiveness, responsiveness, and the rule of law. Democratic Participant Theory strengthens these principles by positioning the media not merely as an information channel, but as an arena for citizen engagement. When individuals can access media platforms freely and express their views on governance, leadership, and policy, transparency is enhanced. Government actions become more visible and open to public scrutiny, reducing the likelihood of secrecy and abuse of power. The emphasis on active citizen involvement directly supports accountability. When people participate in media processes by questioning decisions, debating policies, and sharing local experiences, leaders are compelled to justify their actions. This continuous interaction between citizens and those in authority creates a system where public officials remain answerable to the people. In this sense, Democratic Participant Theory transforms the media into a mechanism through which accountability is demanded and enforced.

Conclusion

The obvious potentials of broadcast media have continued to make these channels of communication unique among the various media channels that include the digital media platforms. As traditional media channels that have gained popularity among audiences since its emergence and development, particularly in Nigeria, the broadcast media remain relevant, active and widely accessed by the audiences in the contemporary times. This positioned the broadcast media at the centre of political discourse as it regards its role in political mobilisation, participation and promotion of good governance. Numerous programme contents on international and national television and radio stations that include interviews, current affairs and discussions are becoming engaging and popular because of the political contents that include issues around good governance. National television stations such as Channels Television, TVC, and Arise TV have been demonstrating capacity in terms of providing platforms and forums for political discourse and conversations. Equally, local or broadcast stations operating at sub-government levels such as Freedom Radio, Pyramid FM and Rahma Radio in a place like Kano also broadcast programmes that encourage political participation and promote good governance.

Thus, it is argued here that despite the challenges facing the Nigerian broadcast stations, their effort in consolidating democracy and promoting good governance such as transparency, accountability, fairness and

justice cannot be ignored especially as the country approaches the 2027 general elections and the expectations of good governance appear to be growing higher. The efforts of the Nigerian broadcast media in recent time suggest that the broadcast media are consolidating on their traditional role of serving the people with focused content to promote good governance.

References

1. Abraham (2021). Role of media in good governance. International Journal of Creative Research Thoughts 9(1), 1177 -1184.

2. Akingbohungbe, O. (2025, September, 7). Role of media towards attainment good governance in Nigeria. The Guardian. https://guardian.ng/opinion/role-of-media-towards-attainment-good-governance-in-nigeria/

3. Baym, G. (2010). From Cronkite to Colbert: The evolution of broadcast news. New York, NY: Oxford University Press.

4. Baran,S. J.,& Davis,D.K.(2012). Mass communication theory, foundations, ferment, future. United States: Wadsworth Cengage

5. Baym, G. (2013). Political Media as Discursive Modes: A Comparative Analysis of Interviews with Ron Paul from Meet the Press, Tonight, The Daily Show, and Hannity. International Journal of Communication, 7, 489-507

6. Bellver, A., & Kaufmann, D. (2005). Trans parenting transparency: initial empirics and policy applications, World Bank policy research working paper, (forthcoming) (Washington) http://www.worldbank.org/wbi/ governance

7. Curran, J. (2002). Media and Power. Routledge

8. Jibo, M. & Okoosi-Simbine, A.T. (2003). The Nigerian media: An assessment of its role in achieving transparent and accountable government in the Fourth Republic. Nordic Journal of African Studies 12(2), 180-195.

9. Malam, M. N. (2022). Broadcast Media and Politics in Northern Nigeria. In Gambo, D. (Eds) Media Industry in Northern Nigeria 1960-2020, Pp 211-220. Jos: University of Jos Press.

10. McQuail, D. (2010). The rise of mass media. In McQuail, D. (ed) Mass Communication Theory, pp 23-48. London: Sage Publishers.

11. Olaiya. T. A. Apeoko, D. O. & Ayeni, O. O. (2013). Factors in mass media, third term. agenda and governance in Nigeria, New Media and Mass Communication 10, 48-63.

12. Olutokun, A. & Seteolu, D. (2001). The media and democratic rule in Nigeria. Development policy management network bulletin, XIII (3).

13. Ogah, I.A. & Abari, O.I. (2023). Harnessing the potentials of broadcasting for good governance in Nigeria

14. Paletz, D. L. (2008). The media in America politics: Contents and consequences. New York: Longman

15. Siraj, I. (2016). 2015 Elections, Political Broadcasting and the Emergence of Neologism: A Study of Freedom Radio FM Political Programme "Ko Wanne Gauta". Bayero Journal of Communication Studies 1(2), 205-216.

16. Usman, F. U. (2026). Politics and Development of Broadcast Media in Kano State 1979-2009. Kano: Bayero University Press.

17. Yusuf, I. U., Abubakar, Y. & Adamu, M. A. (2025). Broadcast Media in Nigeria: Responsibilities and Performances during 2023 General Elections. In Suleiman, Y. O., Soemo, J. S. & Ahmad, M. B. (eds) Communication and Mass Media in Nigeria: Trends, Performance, Perspectives Pp19-31. Zaria: Ahmadu Bello University Press.